Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Dr. Art E. Fact

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Dr. Art E. Fact

Professor of Art History & Provenance Scholar

Art has never met a footnote he could not lengthen. Art has built a career tracing the lives of objects through wars, estates, auctions, private collections, and suspicious gaps in paperwork.

- Supervises **Reed DeLabel**'s doctoral research and sends drafts back covered in notes.
- Secretly infatuated with the enigmatic energy of **Dada DiCapo**. Will she notice him?
- Trusts only **Chip Patina** to say when the physical evidence contradicts Art's theory.

ACTING TIPS

Intense, professorial, curious, occasionally pedantic, sincerely excited by evidence.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Dr. Art E. Fact. I bring decades of scholarship and a footnote for almost every possible dinner conversation. Looking forward to intellectual discussions tonight!

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Dr. Art E. Fact

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Infatuation with Dada makes public intellectual humiliation feel especially unbearable.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Dr. Art E. Fact

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Your reflection cannot look up far enough to see what rests on the mirror.*

2 *Look behind a painting rather than into its scenery.*

3 *The household's Bible has received a very unofficial insert.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Reed found a gap in my ownership citation. Grant found it inconvenient, which is not a scholarly objection. I asked to hold the earlier press copies; he wanted my name on them before the correction. Dada was here. I had hoped to discuss something rather more impressive with her. A ridiculous concern, given the size of the actual error. Still, there it is.

IF MURDERER

Reed found a gap in my ownership citation. Grant could expose it whenever I withdrew authority from his catalog. I asked to hold the earlier press copies; he wanted them circulating first. Dada was here. I had imagined a rather different conversation with her. Grant was going to make sure my most attentive audience heard about the error before anything else.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The purchase attachment said original contents. My draft said inert. I asked Reed to hold the early press copies. Grant said people had paid to see his bottle, not my question mark. I let the preview go ahead. I knew what cyanide meant; I did not need another reference book. Dada, you asked why I was so quiet. I was waiting for somebody with more authority to stop it. I was the authority in that conversation.

IF MURDERER

I asked Reed to restore the collection attachment. My draft used the inert description; a query remained beside it. I attended the preview. Grant wanted me to explain the collection during his toast. I went to his place to object to that introduction. Nobody there. A glass and the speech card with my name on it. I turned the card over and left. Petty, yes. I have apparently reached the stage of my career where I take revenge on stationery.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Dr. Art E. Fact

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> My query says original contents. I wrote it; I knew what the words meant. The answer was unresolved, keep closed. I let the paying guests hear inert. There is no better version of that sentence. Dada, would you mind not looking at me for a moment? I prepared for every conversation we might have tonight except this one.

IF MURDERER

> I had not read the purchase condition before the gala. My query concerned the object's history. The loan description was my source; the dealer attachment was outside my research then. My ownership citation was poor. Reed, you may say that. Dada, I would rather you hadn't heard any of this. I have become very foolish about who is listening.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP

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BALLOT

Dr. Art E. Fact

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Dr. Art E. Fact

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. My dated query quotes the contents condition; intake answered that it remained unresolved. I let the entry proceed. Reed, your finding deserves your name. Dada, the invitation to dinner I kept disguising as a discussion of your work was an invitation to dinner. You need not answer it tonight. I am trying to say one thing without a footnote.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I had read the condition. My own query quotes it. I denied that knowledge because it explained why I knew the bottle might still hold its original contents. I took the poison during the preview and used it in Grant's private glass. The ownership correction was not going to stop him circulating my mistake. I decided to stop him instead. I have spent a career distinguishing an object from the story sold with it. Dada, you need not explain your work to me. Reed, you need never seek my approval. I have used my knowledge for the smallest possible purpose.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.